Orienteer of the Year 2026

How the results were calculated

Prepared November 2026. It covers the events used, where the data came from, how it was cleaned, how points were calculated, the checks made, and the decisions still to confirm.

Summary

- **10 OY events**, best **6** count, at least **4** events to win a class, at least **2** AS courses to win an AS class.
- **23 class winners**, all found in the August 2026 members list. M35A, M85A, MOB and WOB have no winner (no one reached 4 events).
- Results for every event were read from Eventor. 646 runs at OY events were scored, 581 of them by members of SA clubs, giving totals for 154 people.
- Points are calculated with the OY 2025 code, with three changes: data comes from Eventor, AS and OB classes offered are read from each event's Eventor page, and an A result now counts for your AS class at any event where your AS class is not offered (this was a manual correction in 2025).
- The same code reproduces all 23 published 2025 winners.

1. Events

The 2026 OY events were confirmed in November 2026. EP Champs (Sandmine, 30 August) is not an OY event in 2026. SA Middle Champs (Rawnsley, 8 June) is included.

#	Event	Date	Eventor event	AS classes offered	OB	Finishers
1	SprintChamps	1 Mar	SA Sprint Championships - Scotch College	none	N	99
2	Wirreanda	29 Mar	Wirreanda Farm OY	M21AS, M45AS, M55AS, M65+AS, W21AS, W45AS, W55AS, W65+AS	Y	80
3	LongChamps	7 Jun	SA Long Championships - Mannawarra - near Wilpena Pound	M21AS, M45AS, M55AS, M65+AS, W21AS, W45AS, W55AS, W65+AS	Y	139
4	MiddleChamps	8 Jun	SA Middle Distance Championships - Rawnsley	none	Y	123
5	SimmondsHill	26 Jul	Simmonds Hill foot O & MTBO	M21AS, M45AS, M55AS, M65+AS, W21AS, W45AS, W55AS, W65+AS	Y	76
6	Briglen	9 Aug	Briglen-Tundarri OY	M21AS, M45AS, M55AS, M65+AS, W21AS, W45AS, W55AS, W65+AS	Y	65
7	NightChamps	22 Aug	Cobblers Creek (SA Night Champs) OY	M21AS, M45AS, W21AS, W45AS	Y	55
8	MtBarker	30 Aug	Mt Barker - Sprint OY Event - Note an early PM event on Sunday	none	N	83
9	KeynesGap	20 Sep	Keynes Gap OY	none	Y	69
10	MTBO	24 Oct	SA MTBO Championships, Mt Crawford Goldfields	none	N	16

AS and OB classes offered are taken from the Class information on each event's Eventor page. Night Champs offered only 21AS and 45AS. Sprint Champs, Middle Champs, Mt Barker, Keynes Gap and MTBO Champs offered no AS classes.

2. Data sources

Source	Used for
Eventor result lists (eventor.orienteering.asn.au)	Results for all 10 events: class, course length, place, time, club and Eventor person Id.
Eventor event pages	Classes offered (AS and OB) and officials (course setters and controllers).

Source	Used for
Members in Orienteering SA Aug 2026.xlsx	Year of birth and sex, matched by Eventor Id (or by name). Checking that winners are members.
table_30268886_1793869208.xlsx (Eventor export)	Year of birth for anyone not in the members list. It only contains club events, so the state events (Sprint, Long, Middle, Briglen, MTBO Champs) were not in it.
2024-5 data	Year of birth for anyone still missing (OSA members list 2024 and the 2025 OE files).
More Data folder (OE csv, skb and XML files)	Cross-checking the Eventor results (see section 6).
9_OY_PointsCalculationandRules.pdf, 1_OSA_Course_Specifications.pdf p13	The rules applied (section 4).

3. Data cleaning

- **Finishers only.** Runs without a place and time (did not start, did not finish, mispunched, not competing) are not scored.
- **Class names** are changed to the OY names: WOpenB to WOB, M65AS / M65 AS / W65A+AS to M65+AS or W65+AS, JuniorB to OB, 18 to 20.
- **Simmonds Hill:** only foot O results are used; the MTBO and e-bike courses at that event are ignored.
- **Year of birth** (in this order): members list by Eventor Id, Eventor export by Id, members list by name, Eventor export by name, 2024-5 data by name. Every SA club runner at an OY event had a year of birth. The only runners without one were interstate or casual entrants, who are not scored but still count when finding the best time.
- **SA clubs:** a person is included if any of their OY results that year is for an OSA club (including Orienteering SA individual members and Top End). Casual and interstate entrants are excluded from the totals.

4. How points are calculated

Points for each run

- Run rate = time / course length (minutes per km).
- Points = 1000 x best run rate in the class / your run rate, rounded. The best run rate includes everyone who finished in that class, including interstate and casual entrants.
- Age = 2026 minus year of birth. Juniors are placed in the even age above (e.g. 15 is in 16), 17-20 in 20, 21-34 in 21, then 35, 45, 55, 65, 75, 85.

A classes

- A run counts for your A class if you ran your own class or a longer course (a younger senior class, or an older junior class).
- If you have results in more than one A class, your points for the other class at each event are worked out against that class's best run rate (maximum 1000; 1000 if no one ran that class).
- If a person has totals in more than one class, they are placed in the class where they have the most points, and can only win one class.

AS classes

- You must run the AS course for your age: 21AS (under 45), 45AS, 55AS or 65+AS. Running a different AS class does not count.
- You need at least 2 AS courses in your AS class to be eligible, and 4 events in total.
- **Where your AS class is not offered at an event, your result in your own A class counts towards your AS class.** In 2025 this only applied at events with no AS classes at all, and was corrected by

hand for Teri McComb (Night Champs). It is now built in. In 2026 it adds Mark Richmond's Night Champs M55A result (815) to M55AS, which does not change his total.

- Night Champs: the highest AS class offered is 45AS, so people aged 55 and over can count a 45AS run (as in 2025).

Open B

- MOB and WOB results count. For anyone who has run OB, their results at events with no OB class also count towards OB.

MTBO Champs

- Riders are scored against the best in their MTBO class, and the points count for the A class of their age group (as in 2025).

Officials

- Course setters and controllers listed on each event's Eventor page get official points (not event directors). Anyone who finished a course at that event does not.
- Official points = the average of all your OY points for the year, counted in each class you have run. Maximum of 2 sets per person (the earliest events). The 2025 code allowed 3; the rules say 2.

Event	Official	Role	Result
SprintChamps	Lexie Ashforth	course setter	official points (953)
SprintChamps	Robin Uppill	event controller	official points (903)
Wirreanda	Jenny Casanova	course setter	official points (986)
LongChamps	Evelyn Colwell	course setter	official points (960)
LongChamps	Jenny Casanova	event controller & course controller	official points (986)
MiddleChamps	Desmond Norman	course setter	official points (763)
MiddleChamps	Nigel Dobson	course controller	official points (744)
SimmondsHill	Ian Grivell	course setter	official points (709)
SimmondsHill	Phil Hazell	course setter	no points - set the MTBO courses; only foot O results are used
Briglen	Phil Hazell	course setter	official points (919)
NightChamps	Ethan Penck	course setter	official points (964)
NightChamps	Nigel Dobson	event controller	official points (744)
NightChamps	Remi Afnan	course setter	official points (800)
KeynesGap	Dante Afnan	course setter	no points - ran at this event
KeynesGap	Remi Afnan	course setter	official points (800)
MTBO	Nigel Dobson	event controller	no points - more than 2 sets
MTBO	Steve Sullivan	course setter	no points - no OY results to average

Mt Barker Sprint: the course setters (Rhys Fogarty, Lucinda Fogarty and Sandra McKean) are not listed on Eventor and were not given official points, because it makes no difference to any winner. With them, Lucinda Fogarty (W20A) would go from 5218 to 5308 (still second), Rhys Fogarty (M45A) from 1000 to 2000 (2 events, not eligible), and Sandra McKean would get nothing because she ran at Mt Barker.

Totals

- Total = sum of your best 6 events in the class. You need 4 events to win. Winners must be financial members of an OSA club (all 23 are in the August 2026 members list).

5. Results

Class	Winner	Events	Total	Next eligible
M16A	Euan Farquharson	6	5980	Ryan McDonnell 5589
M20A	Duncan Still	6	5981	Marcus Cazzolato 4131
M21A	Jack Marschall	6	5083	Ethan Penck 4821
M45A	Reuben Smith	6	6000	Ryan Farquharson 4903
M55A	Greg Morcom	6	5855	Kev Knowles 5704
M65A	Andrew McComb	6	5935	Phil Hazell 5515
M75A	Paul Hoopmann	6	6000	Adrian Uppill 5526
W16A	Ngaire Cassey	4	3632	-
W20A	Adeline Richmond	6	5453	Lucinda Fogarty 5218
W21A	Evalin Brautigam	5	4626	Vanessa Round 3752
W35A	Bridget Uppill	4	3905	-
W45A	Jenny Casanova	6	5860	Fern Hillyard 5422
W55A	Patsy Burley	6	5984	Zara Soden 5521
W65A	Robin Uppill	6	5653	Meredith Rasch 5365
W75A	Carol Such	6	5735	Sue Bament 4423
M21AS	Tyson Hillyard	6	5377	Marcus Cazzolato 4479
M45AS	Mark McDonnell	5	3880	-
M55AS	Mark Richmond	6	5800	Patrick Burley 3364
M65+AS	Robert Boekelaar	4	3645	Aylwin Lim 3044
W21AS	Lexie Ashforth	6	5953	Jessica Jarvis 2302
W45AS	Rebecca Boulton	6	5328	Kate Marschall 4989
W55AS	Sandra Afnan	6	5268	Erica Diment 3063
W65+AS	Teri McComb	4	3248	-

The full results (every person in every class, with points for each event) are in OY 2026.pdf, Totals 2026.csv and the Totals sheet of OY 2026 Results.xlsx. The All runs sheet shows the time, course length, best time and points for every run.

6. Checks

The code reproduces 2025

- OY 2025.R, run unchanged on the 2025 files, gives 22 of the 23 published winners. The difference (W65+AS) is the manual correction for Teri McComb.
- With the AS change above, it reproduces the corrected 2025 result for Teri McComb exactly (3484).
- The new code, run on the 2025 events from Eventor with the 2025 officials list, gives all 23 published 2025 winners. Some totals differ, mainly because:
  - Narrinyeri Hills 2025: the 2025 file had no years of birth, so runners missing from the year of birth list got no points there. Eventor and the members list fill these in.
  - Bri Glen 2025 M55A: a non-competitive run (Steve Cooper, 52:41) was counted as the best time in 2025. Eventor does not give times for non-competitive runs, so they never set the best time.

The 2026 data matches the files supplied

Event	Supplied file	Result
Wirreanda, Keynes Gap	OE / Eventor csv	Identical: same finishers, classes, places, times and course lengths.

Event	Supplied file	Result
MTBO Champs	Eventor csv	Identical apart from course length rounding (22.06 vs 22.0 km), which does not change points.
Sprint Champs	OE csv	Identical, except Eventor has 3 extra finishers: Frank Tomas and Peter Kreminski (M85A) and Amy Simpkin (6F). No effect on any winner.
Middle Champs	OE IOF XML	Identical (123 finishers). Re-running with the XML file instead of Eventor gives exactly the same totals.
Long Champs, Simmonds Hill, Briglen, Night Champs, Mt Barker	OE backup (.skb)	Every finisher used is in the file. Times could not be checked without OE.
Club events in the Eventor export	table xlsx	Same finishers as Eventor for every OY event in it.

7. To confirm

- **Officials not given points:** Phil Hazell at Simmonds Hill (set the MTBO courses; only foot O used), Dante Afnan at Keynes Gap (ran), Nigel Dobson at MTBO Champs (already has 2 sets: Middle and Night Champs), Steve Sullivan at MTBO Champs (no OY results to average).
- **Closest results:** M55A Greg Morcom 5855 vs Kev Knowles 5704 (151 points). M65+AS is now Robert Boekelaar 3645 vs Aylwin Lim 3044, because Aylwin directed Middle Champs and directors do not get official points.
- **For future years:** should a non-competitive run ever set the best time? The rules do not say. It made a difference once in 2025 (Bri Glen M55A) and not at all in 2026.